

medal at the Sultan of Johor Cup.

Sreejesh quickly found his footing in his new role, achieving his maiden title as the India Colts triumphed in the Men's Junior Asia Cup, defeating arch-rival Pakistan 5-3 in a thrilling final.

With this victory, India extended its record, winning the tournament for the fifth time, having previously claimed the title in 2023, 2015, 2008, and 2004.

Similarly, the Indian women's team successfully defended its Junior Asia Cup title, edging out China 3-2 in a dramatic penalty shootout in the final.

Resurgence of Hockey India League

The Hockey India League made its comeback after a seven-year hiatus, with a new women's competition also making its debut, creating fervour for the sport in the country.

Eight men's and four women's teams were officially announced, making it the first professional franchise league to have both men and women playing concurrently.

Harmanpreet and Udit Duhan were the top picks in their respective auction pools, going for Rs 78 lakh to Soorma Hockey Club and Rs 32 lakh to Shrachi Rarh Bengal Tigers, respectively.

Senior National Championships

Odisha made history by winning the 14th Hockey India Senior Men's National Championship 2024, claiming the title in its maiden final appearance. Odisha triumphed over two-time champion Haryana with a commanding 5-1 victory to secure the top honour.

In the women's competition, Hockey Haryana emerged victorious against Hockey Maharashtra in a thrilling final, clinching the title with a 3-0 win in a penalty shootout.

IN 2025...

While the full impact of the HIL 2024-25 season remains to be seen, players – particularly the younger ones – will look to leverage the competition as a testing ground to establish themselves as key contributors at the international level.

The new Olympic cycle will commence with the opening leg of the men's and women's FIH Pro League 2024-25 seasons, set to begin in February in Bhubaneswar. With qualification spots for the 2026 Hockey World Cup and the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics at stake for the league winners, both teams will aim to identify and nurture emerging talent from domestic competitions.

Rajgir will host the Men's Asia Cup 2025 from August 27 to September 7, where Craig Fulton's team will seek to reclaim the title after finishing third in the previous edition in 2022. Meanwhile, the India Colts will take centre stage as the host nation of the FIH Junior Men's World Cup 2025 in December, with the exact dates yet to be announced. On the domestic front, the 15th edition of the Senior Women's National Championship is scheduled for March, followed by the men's tournament in April.